

One Must Act: A Theory of Whole Before Multiply

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How this was written: Patrick wrote the first draft of the theory and its principle. An AI editor (Claude) structured it, tightened the language, formalized the math, corrected two arithmetic slips, and added the comparisons, worksheet, skills and open questions. The theory, its name and its core claims are Patrick's. His original draft is preserved word for word at the end.

Abstract

One Must Act holds that any goal is reached by multiplication, and multiplication only works on a whole. Call the goal **100**, your starting point **0**, a complete and working foundation **1**, and the people, systems and resources you add **2 through 99**. You cannot multiply your way to 100 from a fraction: a 0.99 foundation shortchanges every multiplier you add.

So the work runs in a fixed order. Name the 100. Define the 1. Choose your multipliers carefully, because each one carries a share of the distance. Then start from 0, today, and measure the result in reality, not in your head. The theory applies at any scale, from a single day to a company.

The principle in one line

A goal is reached only when a whole foundation (1) is multiplied by the right contributors (2–99) until the result measured in reality reaches the goal (100) — and nothing moves until you act from where you stand now (0).

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0 \;\rightarrow\; 1 \;\rightarrow\; 1 \times (\text{multipliers } 2\text{--}99) \;\rightarrow\; 100
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The principle, in the author's words

Lightly edited for clarity from Patrick's first draft. The ideas and order are unchanged.

100 is the goal: the final output and the definite, intended result. To get to 100, you must have 1. But 1 cannot multiply against itself; it needs another, 2 or more. You cannot multiply less than a whole. A fraction times any multiple falls short of what a whole would produce. Therefore you cannot multiply unless you are 1, whole and complete. Then you must add the correct multiples, the team (2–99), to get there.

Whoever you choose to multiply with determines the remainder each of you must carry. You and one partner each carry half, 50 of the 100. With two partners, three of you each carry about 33. So you must be selective and accurate about who enters this multiplication team. It is vital that it goes right, so you can reach the goal.

You cannot get to 1 without starting from 0: your starting point, where you are now.

I call this theory One Must Act, because to achieve a goal it must exist in life and not just in your mind. Your mind is a chalkboard, a canvas on which to create, but the result must be measured in reality, and reality follows the principles of math. If you reach 100, you reach your goal, or more. If you do not, it is not necessarily a failure: you can identify why you fell short, or be content with 99, close enough.

No matter what, it must have a structured process. First, choose your end goal: definite and specific. Then choose your 1: what must exist for the goal to be possible. Next, decide who or what you must add, once the 1 is complete, to reach the next stages. Finally, start from where you are now, at whatever stage, and begin.

This is a structure for creating and managing life in any area, high level or low. It can and must be applied, until or unless someone creates a more positive alternative.

The four quantities

Every goal has the same four parts. Each answers a different question and has its own test for "done."

Quantity	Name	Question it answers	Done when
100	The goal	What exactly do I want, and by when?	It is specific, measurable, dated, and someone else could check it.

Quantity	Name	Question it answers	Done when
1	The whole	What must exist, working end to end, for the goal to be possible?	It works without excuses, on its own, and can be shown to someone.
2-99	The multipliers	Who or what will I add to the 1, and what share does each carry?	Each has a named role, a share of the distance, and proof it adds more than it costs.
0	The start	Where am I really, today?	It is written down and measured, not imagined.
T	The threshold (99)	What result will I accept as success?	It was set before the work began.

The order of definition runs $100 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 2-99 \rightarrow 0$. The order of work runs the other way: $0 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 2-99 \rightarrow 100$. You plan from the end and build from the beginning.

The laws of One Must Act

Ten statements define the theory. Each can be tested, argued with and extended.

1. **The Law of the Definite End.** A goal that is not specific, measurable and dated is not a 100. It is a wish.
2. **The Law of Reality.** A goal exists only when it exists outside the mind. The mind designs; reality measures.
3. **The Law of the Whole.** Nothing multiplies until it is 1: complete, working and provable on its own.
4. **The Law of the Fraction.** A fraction times any multiplier falls short of a whole times the same multiplier, and the gap widens as you scale. ($0.99 \times 2 = 1.98$, not 2)
5. **The Law of the Other.** 1 cannot multiply itself ($1 \times 1 = 1$). Growth requires another.
6. **The Law of Selection.** Every multiplier changes the result. One below 1 shrinks it, and one at 0 erases it. Choose carefully.
7. **The Law of Shares.** The distance to 100 is divided among the team. Each member must be able to carry their share.
8. **The Law of the Start.** Every journey begins at 0, the honest present. You cannot skip to 1 from an imagined position — and $0 \times \text{anything}$ is still 0 until you act.

9. **The Law of Order.** Define from the end ($100 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 99 \rightarrow 0$). Build from the start ($0 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 99 \rightarrow 100$).
10. **The Law of the Honest Result.** Falling short is information, not failure. Measure the gap, name its cause, and either correct course or accept the threshold you set in advance.

The math

The outcome is your wholeness times everything you multiply it by. Two lenses describe the same idea: one shows why a fraction fails, the other shows how the work is shared.

Lens 1: wholeness times multipliers

Let W be how complete your foundation is, from 0 (nothing exists) to 1 (whole). Let each multiplier you add be m_1, m_2 and so on.

$$0 = W \times m_1 \times m_2 \times \cdots \times m_k \quad \text{goal: } \geq 100$$

Four consequences follow directly:

1. **A fraction shortchanges every multiplier.** The shortfall is $(1 - W) \times M$, where M is the total multiplier. It grows as you scale. At $M = 100$, a 99% foundation loses 1 point; a 70% foundation loses 30.
2. **$1 \times 1 = 1$.** Alone, a whole stays the same size. Growth needs at least one factor greater than 1.
3. **A bad multiplier shrinks the result.** Any factor below 1 — a partner who drains more than they add — makes the outcome smaller than if they were never added. A partner rated 0.8 is a 20% tax on everything else.
4. **A zero anywhere makes everything zero.** If any required factor is missing entirely, no amount of effort elsewhere reaches 100.

Lens 2: sharing the distance

Once you are 1, every member of the team (you included) carries a share of the distance to 100.

$$\text{share per member} = \frac{100}{n} \quad n = 1 + \text{number of multipliers}$$

Team	n	Share each carries
You alone	1	100
You + 1 partner	2	50
You + 2 partners	3	about 33.3
You + 4 partners	5	20
You + 9 partners	10	10

Shares do not have to be equal. Assign them on purpose, matched to what each member can actually deliver. When members are not fully whole, count each by their wholeness w : the multiple the team needs becomes $100 \div (w_1 + w_2 + \dots)$. You at 0.9 plus one whole partner need about 52.6 each instead of 50. A member who cannot carry their share leaves a remainder someone else must absorb.

The threshold

Before you start, decide what result you will accept. Call it **T**. If 100 is the goal, T might be 99: close enough to count as success. If you end below T, the math tells you where to look: was W below 1, was a multiplier below 1, or was a required factor zero?

Two corrections to the first draft

- **$0.99 \times 2 = 1.98$, not 1.88.** The point still holds: a fraction times a multiplier can grow (1.98 is more than 0.99), but it always falls short of what a whole would produce with the same multiplier ($1 \times 2 = 2$).
- **$3 \times 33 = 99$, not 100.** 100 cannot be split evenly among three ($100 \div 3 = 33.33\dots$). This may be a real finding: for some team sizes, 99 is built into the arithmetic. See Open questions.

The method

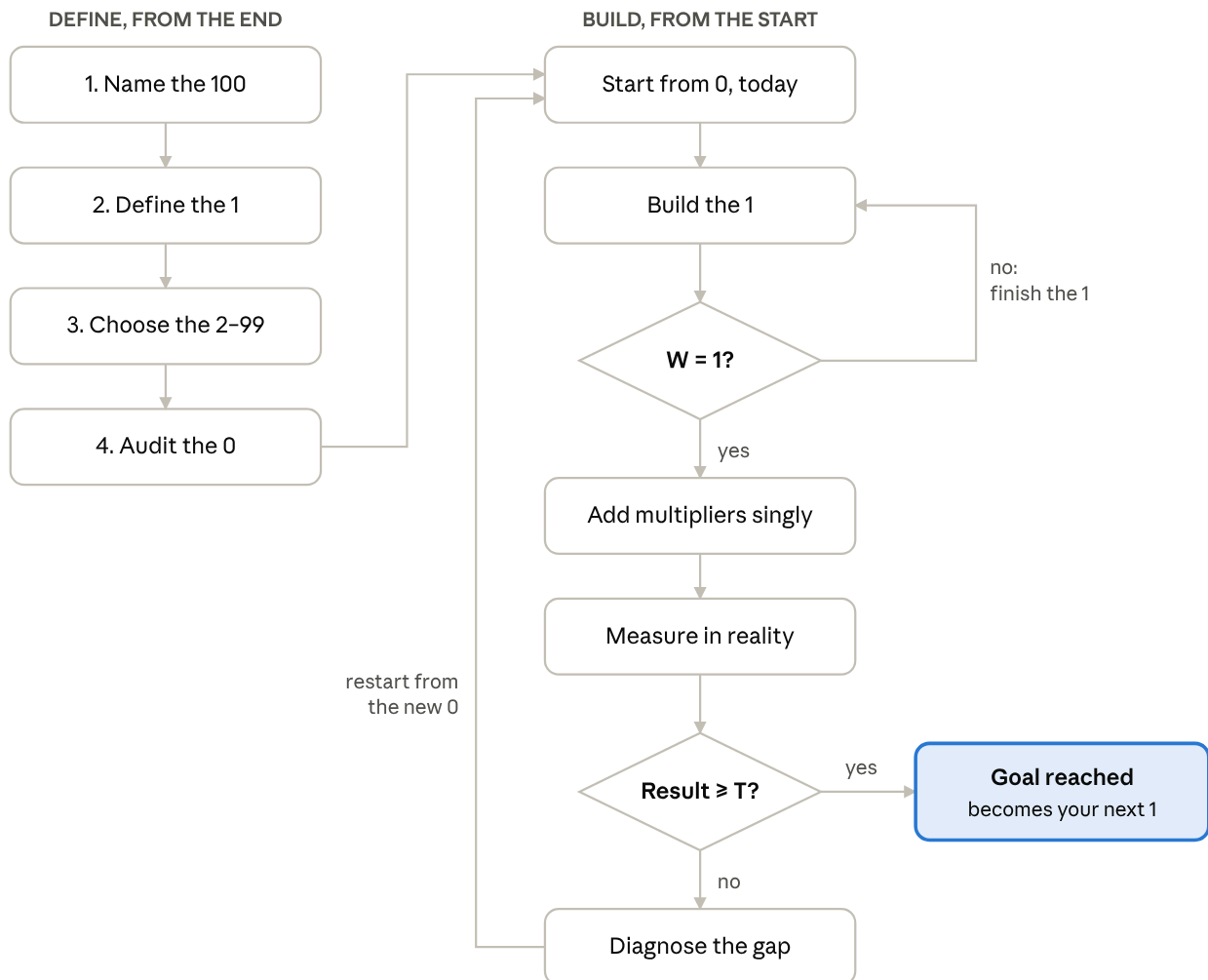
Define the four parts from the end, then build from the start. Two gates keep the work honest: **you multiply only once you are whole**, and **the result is measured against the threshold you set in advance**.

1. **Name the 100.** Write the outcome, the number and the date. Set the threshold T.

2. **Define the 1.** List what must exist, working end to end, for the 100 to be possible. Give each item a test.
3. **Choose the 2-99.** Decide who or what will multiply the 1, the share each carries, and the stage where each joins.
4. **Audit the 0.** Write down where you really are today.
5. **Act.** Sort your next actions with NPAO — clear Necessities (hard blockers) first, then Anxieties (friction that drags on everything), then Priorities (the mission work), then Opportunities (growth). Take the first one today.

Then build. Finish the 1 before adding anyone. Add multipliers one at a time, measure in reality, and either reach the goal or diagnose the gap and start again from the new 0. A plan is not active until its first real-world action has started and produced evidence.

Plan from the end, build from the start, multiply only once whole



The two diamonds are the gates: nothing is multiplied until $W = 1$, and a result below T sends you to diagnosis and a new 0 , not to blame.

The integrated system: how FPE, PAL, JTBD, NPAO and ROSTR kick in

One Must Act is the equation. Patrick's other frameworks are the machinery that runs it: **FPE is the standard every step is held to, and PAL, JTBD, NPAO and ROSTR each take over at a specific point** between 0 and 100.

FPE — the standard: Finish. Process. Effective.

FPE is Patrick's working philosophy, and it maps onto the theory one to one.

FPE	What it means	Where it lives in One Must Act	The test
Finish	Always ship complete things. No half-built products, no "v1," "MVP," "TBD" or placeholders in anything a customer sees.	The 1. Finish is the Law of the Whole in practice: nothing is multiplied until it is finished.	Is $W = 1$? Would a stranger call it complete?
Process	Work from repeatable systems, not floating ideas. Package what works as skills, templates and checklists.	The method and the worksheet. The fixed order (define from the end, build from the start) is the process.	Could someone else run it again and get the same result?
Effective	Build things that are beautiful, useful and complete — judged by results, not effort.	The 100 and the threshold. Effectiveness is measured in reality against the goal.	Did the result reach T or 100, with evidence?

Read together: **Finish makes the 1, Process carries it through the multipliers, Effective measures whether it reached 100.** A step that fails any of the three is a fraction.

Where each framework takes over

Stage	One Must Act question	Framework that kicks in	What it produces	5D phase
Intake	What is being asked?	ROSTR · Capture (the SOP intake)	The raw request, saved as source	—
The 100	What exactly do I want, and by when?	PAL (Prompt Abstraction Layer): extract intent → inject context → enhance → compile	A structured intent: the stated and latent goal, a candidate 100, a candidate 1, the 0 inventory, unknowns	PreD
The 0	Where am I really?	RAG DAL (Dynamic Acquisition Layer) + the Rostr Hub / ContextEngine memory	Evidence with source credibility; what is already known from past sessions	PreD
The 1	What must exist for the 100 to be possible?	JTBD — ROSTR's Analyze step	The job the user is hiring the product to do; the 1 is the smallest thing that completes that job end to end	Design
Building the 1	What do I do first?	NPAO — Necessity → Anxiety → Priority → Opportunity	An ordered task list: blockers first, friction second, mission work third, growth last	Development
The gate	Is it finished?	FPE · Finish	W = 1, or back to building	Development

Stage	One Must Act question	Framework that kicks in	What it produces	5D phase
The 2-99	Who or what multiplies it?	ROSTR · Compile → Ship: PAL compiles instruction packs; agents in the Rostr Hub registry are multipliers	Approved multipliers, each with a share and a stage	Deployment
Uncertain multipliers	Is this factor above 1?	NX / NXI — known (X), unknown (N), interference (I)	A weighted estimate of each factor, including how multipliers affect each other	Deployment
Measure and diagnose	Did it reach T?	FPE · Effective + the Diagnose checklist	The result, the gap, and the new 0	Debugging

ROSTR (Runtime, Orchestration, State, Tools, Reference) is the operating system underneath all of it: PAL is its compilation layer, NPAO its decision layer, RAG DAL and the agents its execution layer, and the Reference Hub its memory. In sales and agency work the same system runs as **Capture (SOP) → Analyze (JTBD) → Compile (PAL) → Ship (Agent)** — which is One Must Act's $0 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow$ multiply, in ROSTR's own words.

In one sentence: PAL names the 100, RAG DAL proves the 0, JTBD defines the 1, NPAO orders the work, FPE gates the 1 and judges the result, ROSTR runs the multipliers, and NX weighs the ones you can't yet see.

Worked examples at three scales

The same four parts work for a personal goal, a product and a company. Only the size of the numbers changes.

Scale	100 (goal)	1 (the whole)	2–99 (multipliers)	0 (start)
Personal: an artist's debut project	A 6-track EP released on all platforms by a set date, with 1,000 first-month streams	Six finished, mixed and mastered songs, plus artwork, owned outright	Mix engineer, distributor, playlist pitching, two features, a release-week show	Two finished demos, no engineer, no budget set
Product: the Artispreneur EPK builder	A kit a booker can act on in seconds, scored 90+ and ready for its audience	Five foundation items: name, genre and real email; press photo; latest release; a listen link; a real bio	Verified stats, press quotes, shows, rider, discography depth, engagement data	An intake form that invented an email address when one was missing
Company: Artispreneur	Acquisition for \$10B cash by October 1, 2033, at \$200M ARR	A working platform that can scale, whole and complete	Partners, customers, team, investors, vendors, family and friends, God	The state audited on October 1, 2026

The product row is already built into software: the EPK builder scores each kit on this ladder, and its extras earn no points until the five foundation items are complete. The company row comes from Artispreneur's own game plan and is worked through in full in the worksheet below.

How it strengthens your other frameworks

One Must Act works best as the **goal layer** that sits above your other frameworks: it says *what* must be true and *in what order*; the others say *how* to get there.

Framework	What it does today	Where One Must Act plugs in	Suggested upgrade
FPE (Finish. Process. Effective.)	Personal execution standard	Finish = a whole 1. Process = the five steps. Effective = measured against 100.	Make "Finish" mean "the 1 is proven whole," so FPE has a pass/fail test.
PAL	Prompt Abstraction Layer: compiles a raw ask into a structured intent manifest	PAL defines the 100. Its output should always include a candidate 100, a candidate 1 and a 0 inventory.	Treat a PAL output with no 100 as incomplete.
NPAO (Necessity, Priority, Anxiety, Opportunity)	Ranks and sequences tasks	Orders next actions within the current stage, run $N \rightarrow A \rightarrow P \rightarrow O$. Its engine — Navigate, Prioritize, Allocate, Orchestrate — places each task in a 5D phase, scores it, assigns a doer and runs it. Necessities usually build the 1; Opportunities usually add multipliers.	Tag each task with the quantity it serves (0, 1, 2-99 or 100). An Opportunity that adds a multiplier waits until $W = 1$.

Framework	What it does today	Where One Must Act plugs in	Suggested upgrade
ROSTR	Runtime, Orchestration, State, Tools, Reference: the agent operating system that runs PAL, RAG DAL and NPAO	Becomes the outer equation: PAL defines the 100, JTBD defines the 1, NPAO orders the next actions, and the 5D phases (PreD → Design → Development → Deployment → Debugging) are the stages between 1 and 100.	Add a wholeness gate after Development: no multipliers join in Deployment until the 1 passes its tests.
NX / NXI	Weighs known (X), unknown (N) and interference (I) factors	Gives NX a fixed target (100) and a concrete question per multiplier: is m above or below 1?	Use the I term to model multipliers that interact — Lens 1 currently assumes they don't.

The biggest gain is in NX/NXI: Lens 1 treats each multiplier as independent, but in real life two partners can amplify or cancel each other. That is exactly what an interference term measures.

Compared with established frameworks

One Must Act does not replace these. It adds two things most of them lack: **a gate** (no multiplying before you are whole) and **a way to reason about who joins the team** (every multiplier carries a share and can shrink the result).

Framework	What it does well	What One Must Act adds
OKRs (Grove, Doerr)	Ties an objective to measurable key results	Blocks growth key results until the foundation is whole; assigns each owner a share of the distance

Framework	What it does well	What One Must Act adds
Lean Startup / MVP (Ries)	Ships early to learn fast	Separates a minimum <i>whole</i> from a minimum <i>fraction</i> . An MVP must work end to end for its narrow job, or it is a 0.9 that gets multiplied
Theory of Constraints (Goldratt)	Finds and fixes the bottleneck	Gives the bottleneck a number: a factor below 1, or at 0, caps the whole product
First Who, Then What (Collins)	Puts the right people in place first	Adds the step before it: become whole first, then choose who multiplies you, and size each person's share
Begin with the End in Mind (Covey)	Plans backward from the goal	Makes the end a number, adds the threshold T, and fixes the build order forward from 0
Jobs to Be Done (Christensen)	Defines success by the customer's job	Supplies the 100: the job, done and measured. The 1 is the smallest product that completes it

What seems new: the multiplicative framing turns "choose good partners" into arithmetic. A partner is not just helpful or unhelpful. They have a factor, and the factor compounds.

Skills and tools built from the theory

The theory now runs as working tools. Each skill file can be copied into any AI tool's skills folder.

Tool	What it does	Where it lives
One Must Act skill	Four modes. Plan turns any goal into a 100, a 1, multipliers and a 0, with next actions, and always writes the full POP document package: Scorecard, Project Brief, JTBD, PRD, Product Specifications, diagrams, KPI framework, Master Doc, Build Guide and Execution Handoff. Vet checks a partner, hire or tool before they join. Diagnose explains why a result fell short. Upgrade tests any framework or plan against the laws.	<code>.claude/skills/one-must-act/SKILL.md</code> and your Claude skills
Calculator	Does the arithmetic: wholeness, outcome, shortfall, required multiplier, team shares, stage and diagnosis. Five tests confirm the laws, including $0.99 \times 2 = 1.98$.	<code>lib/one-must-act.ts</code>
EPK builder readiness	The theory applied to a real product. Every press kit gets a stage and a 0-100 score, and extras count only once the foundation is whole.	<code>lib/epk/epk-builder-engine.ts</code>
EPK builder skill	Carries the same principles into press-kit work in any AI tool.	<code>.claude/skills/epk-builder/SKILL.md</code>

Tool	What it does	Where it lives
Web App Development Process skill	Applies One Must Act to websites and apps: the 1 is a deployed slice where one user completes the core job; integrations must earn their place.	Your Claude skills

To use the skill anywhere: copy the skill file into your AI tool’s skills folder, then say, “Apply One Must Act to [your goal].” The tool asks only for what it cannot infer, then fills in the worksheet at the end of this document.

Open questions to expand the theory

These are the edges where the theory can grow. Each is a possible chapter, essay or experiment.

- ☐ **How do you measure W?** Counting finished foundation items is a start. Weighted items, or a test that the 1 works without its creator present, may be more honest.
- ☐ **Are multipliers multiplied or added?** People often add effort (shares) while their effects multiply (leverage). When does each lens fit, and can one formula hold both?
- ☐ **Is 99 built in?** Three equal members can never split 100 evenly. Is 99 a property of teams, not just a tolerance?
- ☐ **Can a multiplier be measured before it joins?** What is the smallest trial that reveals a factor is above 1?
- ☐ **Does the 1 change as the 100 grows?** A larger goal may need a larger whole. Is there a rule for when to rebuild the foundation?
- ☐ **Can a multiplier become part of the 1?** When does a partner stop multiplying you and become part of your foundation?
- ☐ **Can you be whole in one area and fractional in another?** Health, money, relationships, craft. Do weak areas act as factors below 1 on the others?
- ☐ **Does order matter?** Does adding the right multiplier first make later ones stronger — and can NXI’s interference term measure it?
- ☐ **Time as a multiplier.** Compounding over years behaves like a factor. Can patience be planned like a partner?

- ☐ **Beyond 100.** When a goal is reached, does it become the next 1? That would make the theory a ladder rather than a single climb.
- ☐ **The faith factor.** Artisprenneur’s game plan names God among the multipliers. How should factors outside measurement be held in a theory that insists on measurement?
- ☐ **Testing it.** Track 20 goals, personal and business, with the worksheet. Compare the ones that waited to be whole before multiplying with the ones that did not.

Next draft: pick three questions, answer them with real examples, and publish v0.4.

Worksheet: apply One Must Act to any goal

The worksheet follows the order Patrick wrote it in: **choose the end goal, choose the 1, choose who to add, then start from where you are.** Fill it from Part 1 down; that is the order of definition. Then work it from Part 4 up; that is the order of building. Each part opens with the author’s own words, then the questions, then a table to fill. The **Artisprenneur** company goal runs through every part as the worked example.

Part 1 — Choose your end goal (the 100)

"First, you choose your end goal. Definite, specific."

Ask: *If a stranger checked on the deadline, could they say yes or no without asking me anything?* If not, keep sharpening.

Field	Your answer	Artisprenneur example
The outcome, in one sentence		Artisprenneur is acquired for cash
The number		\$10B cash, at \$200M ARR
The date		October 1, 2033
Who it is for, or who benefits		
How someone else can verify it		A signed acquisition agreement and audited ARR
Where the evidence will come from		

Field	Your answer	Artispreneur example
Threshold T — the 99 you would accept		Not yet set. Decide it now, before the work
"Even more" — what beyond 100 looks like		
Why it matters to you		

Sanity check on the example: \$10B at \$200M ARR is a 50× revenue multiple. Buyers pay that only for unusual growth or strategic value, so it is the goal's biggest assumption — worth writing down as one in Part 4.

Part 2 — Choose your 1 (the whole)

"Then, you choose your 1 — what must exist for it to be possible."

Ask: *If this existed, whole and working, would the 100 become possible? If I took any item away, would it stop working?* Anything that fails the first question is not the 1. Anything that fails the second is extra, and belongs in Part 3.

Artispreneur example: the 1 is "a working platform that can scale, whole and complete." Break it into the items that make it work end to end without excuses — for a platform, that usually means the core job a user completes, the way it earns, and the way it runs without its creator in the room.

Foundation item	Why it must exist	Done when (a test someone else can check)	Owner	Status	Evidence

Find the fractions. List anything that is "almost" done: a decision not made, an owner not named, a test not passed, a dependency not confirmed. Each one keeps W below 1.

What is a fraction right now	What would make it whole	By when

Wholeness score: $W = \text{items done} \div \text{total items} = \text{_____}$. **Gate:** if W is below 1, stop here. Finish the foundation before anyone or anything in Part 3 is added.

Part 3 — Choose who you must add (the 2-99)

"Next you see who you must add to, once completed, for you to get to the next stages." ... "You must be selective and accurate upon who enters this multiplication team."

For every candidate — a person, partner, customer group, investor, vendor, tool, system or channel — answer five questions before they join:

1. **What do they add** that the 1 cannot do alone?
2. **What share of the distance** will they carry?
3. **What evidence** says their factor is above 1, not below it?
4. **What do they cost** — money, time, attention, energy, ownership?
5. **What happens if they turn out to be below 1** — how do you exit?

Who or what	Type	Role	Share of the distance	Estimated factor (m)	Evidence it is above 1	Cost or risk	Enters at stage	Verdict

Verdicts: **Approved** (joins at its stage) · **Candidate** (needs evidence) · **Deferred** (right multiplier, wrong time) · **Rejected** (factor at or below 1).

Artispreneur example: the game plan names seven multipliers. With Patrick plus seven groups, $n = 8$, so an equal share would be 12.5 each — but shares should be set on purpose. The question each must answer:

Multiplier	Question it must answer before it joins
Partners	Which partner, and what does each add that the platform cannot do alone?
Customers	How many, paying what, and what makes them stay?
Team	Which roles come first once the 1 is whole, and what does each own?

Multiplier	Question it must answer before it joins
Investors	How much capital, at which stage, at what cost to ownership?
Vendors	Which services, and what would fail without them?
Family and friends	What support — time, money, belief — and what share can they truly carry?
God	Held as faith rather than a measured factor (see Open questions).

The next stages. The draft says multipliers join "to get to the next stages." Lay the stages out between 1 and 100 so each multiplier has a place to enter.

Stage	Milestone (number + date)	What must be whole at this stage	Multipliers that join here	Gate to move on	Artispreneur example
0 — Start					Audited October 1, 2026
1 — The whole					The platform works end to end and can scale
2					
3					
4					
100 — The goal					\$200M ARR; acquired for \$10B cash by October 1, 2033

Part 4 — Start from where you are now (the 0)

"And finally, you start from where you are now, at whatever stage, and begin." ... "You can not get to 1, without starting from 0."

Write down only what is true today. Hopes go in the right-hand column of the second table, labeled as assumptions.

Area	What exists	What works (proven)	What is missing	What I can spend
Product or craft				
Money				
Time				
Skills				
People and relationships				
Health and energy				
Audience and reputation				
Tools and systems				

Statement I am relying on	Fact or assumption?	How I will verify it

Artispreneur example: the 0 was audited on October 1, 2026. The 50× ARR multiple from Part 1 belongs in the second table as an assumption until a comparable deal or buyer conversation backs it up.

Which stage am I at? Mark it on the stage ladder in Part 3. You begin from that stage, not from the one you wish you were at.

Part 5 — Begin: the next actions (sorted with NPAO)

Sort every candidate action into one NPAO type, then work them in the order **Necessity → Anxiety → Priority → Opportunity**: clear the blockers, then the friction, then the mission work, then growth.

NPAO type	Means	Typical One Must Act work
Necessity	A hard blocker	A missing piece of the 1

NPAO type	Means	Typical One Must Act work
Anxiety	Friction that drags on everything	An unmade decision, an unowned task, a fraction
Priority	Mission-critical work	Building and proving the 1
Opportunity	Growth	Adding a multiplier — only once $W = 1$

Action	NPAO type	Serves (0, 1, 2–99 or 100)	Owner	Due	Proof it is done

Rule: the first action starts today. A plan is not active until it has.

Part 6 — Measure it in reality

"The result must be measured in reality. Which uses the principles of math."

Metric	Where it comes from	Value today	Target at 100	Check-in date

For Artispreneur, the two metrics that define the 100 are already named: **ARR** (target \$200M) and **acquisition value** (target \$10B cash).

Part 7 — Read the result honestly

"If you get to 100, you reach your goal. Even more. If you do not, it may not be a failure."

Result	What it means	What to do
100 or more	Goal reached	Record the evidence. The result becomes the 1 of your next goal.
At or above T	Close enough, as decided in advance	Accept it, record why it fell short of 100, and decide whether to push on.

Result	What it means	What to do
Below T	Not there yet — information, not failure	Run the diagnosis below, correct course, and restart from the new 0.

Diagnosis — find the factor that held it back:

- ☐ Was W below 1? Which foundation item was not whole?
- ☐ Was a multiplier below 1? Who or what drained more than it added — replace or remove it.
- ☐ Was a required factor at 0? What was missing entirely?
- ☐ Did a member fail to carry their share? Who absorbed the remainder?
- ☐ Was the 100 too vague to aim at, or the 0 imagined rather than measured?
- ☐ Was a stage skipped — a multiplier added before its stage?

Write the cause in one sentence, fix that factor, and begin again from where you now are.

Original draft (Patrick Diamitani, unedited)

The equation is this= 100 equals the goal the final output and definitive intended result. In order to get to 100, you must have 1. However, 1 cannot multiply against itself. It must have another (2 or more). You cannot multiply less than a whole. Any fraction, times any multiple, is less ($.99 \times 1 = .99$, $.99 \times 2 = 1.88$). Therefore, you can not multiply unless you are 1. Whole and complete. And then you must add the correct multiples, or team (2-99) to get there. Depending on who or what you decide to multiply you (1 partner = wife) you have that remainder to go. You and wife = 50 x multiple to reach 100. In whatever way. If you choose 2 sources, so 3, you each need 33 x multiple to reach it. You must be selective and accurate upon who enters this multiplication team. It is vital that it go right, so you can reach the goal. You can not get to 1, without starting from 0 = your starting point, and where you are now. I call this theory, One Must Act. Because in order to achieve a goal, it must exist in life and not just your mind. Your mind is a chalkboard, or canvas for which to create. However the result must be measured in reality. Which uses the principles of math. If you get to 100, you reach your goal. Even more. If you do not, it may not be a failure, but you may be able to identify why you did not get there, or be content with 99 (close enough). No matter what, it must have a structured process. So first, you choose your end go. Definite, Specific. Then, you choose your 1 - what must exist for it to be possible. Next you see who you must add to, once completed, for you to get to the next stages. And finally, you start from where you are now, at whatever stage and begin. This is the final goal and structure for creating and managing life. In any area, from high level or low. IT can and must be applied. Until or unless you create another more positive alternative.